

AT BANK OF Baroda (BoB), almost all the women-led branches are profit-making and among the best-performing branches, says its General Manager-Human Resources Management, Swapna Bandopadhyaya. The public sector bank, which is the winner of the BT-KPMG Best Banks and Fintechs Survey 2021-22 in the Talent & Workforce category, shines particularly for its diversity and inclusion initiatives.

Keen on bringing more women into leadership positions to effect real organisational change, the bank began supporting women officials at the chief manager level to remove their mental blocks around promotions and transfers, if any. "Up to the middle-management level, women take promotions, but after that somehow something stops them from rising further," says Bandopadhyaya. Two clear challenges emerged—work-life balance and the requirements of new mothers. "Many organisations provide childcare allowances to their women workforce. However, childcare allowance doesn't really serve the purpose because a lactating mother needs to be with her child for nursing. But having a crèche on-site where she can take a break to nurse the child helps."

BoB now has three on-site crèches at Mumbai, Bengaluru and Vadodara, and plans to open more soon.

The bank, which now has 26 per cent women in its 78,000-strong workforce, also entertains transfer requests of women employees even if there is no vacancy at the host branch but on two grounds—either at the time of marriage or if the spouse is getting transferred.

Persons with disabilities (PWD), who account for 3 per cent

A BANK WITH A PURPOSE

How women, persons with disabilities and sports-people are boosting Bank of Baroda's show

BY VIDYA S.

of the bank's workforce, also form an important part of its DEI (diversity, equity and inclusion) efforts. With SBI Foundation's help, the bank has mapped roles that PWDs can perform, starting from the clerical to officer level. "They are really contributing to the organisation. Though it can't be measured, we feel the impact," she adds.

The merger with Dena Bank and Vijaya Bank in 2019 has also ushered in more diversity. Although BoB didn't have a clearly defined sports policy, the latter two had good cricket, basketball and kabaddi teams. A combined sports policy has improved the bank's discipline and marketing acumen.

"When they go to play wearing BoB T-shirts, they are also creating a brand image for the organisation," says Bandopadhyaya.

The once paper-dependent entity is digitising the workflow within the vertical and between various departments.

"Now, all papers move from one level to another for approval through Sharepoint," she says. As customers no longer want to visit bank branches, it is inculcating a digital mindset among its employees. The bank, which scores high on talent management, has charted out individual development plans for all senior employees. **BT**

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PHOTO BY MANDAR DEODHAR



PEOPLE POWER Swapna Bandopadhyaya, GM (HR Management), Bank of Baroda

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BEST BANK
IN TALENT &
WORKFORCE
BANK OF
BARODA

UNITED BY DIVERSITY

▶ **Women account for 26 per cent of its workforce; BoB has on-site crèches, entertains requests for transfers from women employees even if there are no vacancies at the host branch and its SPARK programme motivates women staff to climb up the ranks**

▶ **After its merger with Dena Bank and Vijaya Bank, Bank of Baroda has created a new sports policy that has in turn improved the bank's discipline and marketing acumen**

▶ **With SBI Foundation's help, the bank has also mapped roles starting from the clerical to officer level that persons with disabilities can perform**